

exuberant, richly colorful style.

KEY WORKS: Violin Concerto, 1940; Gayane, 1942; Spartacus, 1956; Concerto-Rhapsody for Cello and Orchestra, 1963

Samuel Barber

1910–1981, AMERICAN

Barber came from a musical family and began composing at the age of seven. Although there are certain Modernist features in his music, essentially he worked in a fairly conservative, warmly expressive idiom that brought him acclaim and honors throughout his career. Toward the end of his life he said, “There’s no reason music should be difficult for an audience to understand,” and many of his works have indeed achieved broad and enduring popularity (above all, the poignant, elegiac Adagio for Strings, which has often been played or broadcast to accompany or commemorate solemn events). Barber's output was fairly small but highly varied, including symphonies, concertos, operas, ballets, chamber and instrumental music, and numerous songs—which were one of his favorite forms of expression. He was himself an accomplished singer and